

## SKILLS GUIDE



Good language skills for producing reports and communicating with many different types of clients.



The ability to work as part of a team, and to persuade and negotiate with other people.



Excellent analytical skills and an organized, logical, and methodical approach to problem-solving.



Strong numerical skills for calculating estimates and costs, and keeping track of budgets.



Extensive knowledge of commercial building methods, materials, and legislation.



### COST DIRECTOR

Supervises accounts and cost engineers across a variety of projects. This is a more senior and strategic role.



**PROCESS ENGINEER** Helps to manage the processes and facilities in one of many possible energy industries, from oil and gas, to chemical and renewables.

Cost engineers don't only point out inefficiencies—they help fix them.

## RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **CIVIL ENGINEER** *see pp. 176–177*
- ▶ **BUILDING CONTROL OFFICER** Visits sites to ensure that construction workers follow building regulations, such as fire and safety.
- ▶ **CONSTRUCTION INSPECTOR** Inspects project sites to ensure that construction professionals meet health, safety, and quality standards in the plans they draw up.
- ▶ **CONTRACTS MANAGER** Manages all aspects of construction contracts and prepares documents for all project presentations.
- ▶ **SURVEYOR** Uses a range of techniques to survey land, take measurements, and gather data for companies planning to develop an area. They are also known as geomatic surveyors.

## AT A GLANCE



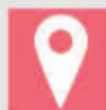
**YOUR INTERESTS** Construction • Structural engineering • Finance • Mathematics • Economics • Civil engineering • Physics • Geography



**ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS** A degree in an industry-related subject, such as industrial engineering or mechanical engineering, is required.



**LIFESTYLE** Cost engineers typically work regular hours. Overtime may be required to meet deadlines, as well as travel to various sites.



**LOCATION** Traveling to meet clients and view sites is common. Working away from home, even overseas, for several months is also common.



**THE REALITIES** Time constraints can be stressful, and long hours may be necessary to complete projects to strict deadlines.